EV CONNECT

PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

EV charging discovery and emergency assistance marketplace

Version	1.0
Date	27 October 2026
Product type	Responsive web application / Progressive Web App (PWA)
Initial market	Bengaluru, Karnataka, India
Initial target segment	Electric two-wheeler users
Status	Initial product specification

Product principle: Build trust and reliability first, monetise useful access second, and expand only when real usage demonstrates demand.

Prepared as a working specification for product planning and software development.

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1. Executive Summary

1.1 Product Overview

EV Connect is a web-based platform designed to help electric vehicle (EV) users find charging locations and access compatible roadside assistance when they cannot conveniently reach a charging point.

The platform combines three core services:

- **Find EV Charging:** A free charging-station discovery service.
- **Get Nearby Help:** A marketplace connecting EV users with suitable, available assistance providers.
- **Earn by Helping:** A provider platform where eligible individuals and businesses can offer compatible charging access or approved roadside assistance and earn money.

The product addresses difficulty discovering accurate charging locations, uncertainty about compatibility, and trouble finding suitable assistance when an EV battery runs low.

1.2 Product Vision

> **To make EV charging discovery and roadside assistance more accessible, reliable and convenient for EV users.**

1.3 Product Mission

Help EV users discover charging options and connect with compatible assistance providers through a simple, transparent and mobile-friendly platform.

1.4 Product Value Proposition

- **EV users:** Free station discovery, compatibility information, nearby assistance, confirmed provider availability and transparent pricing.
- **Providers:** Local customer discovery, service and equipment listings, request management and earning opportunities.
- **EV community:** Contributions to missing station listings and corrections that improve local data quality.

2. Problem Statement

2.1 Problems Faced by EV Users

A. Charging station discovery

Charging stations may be missing from preferred maps, incorrectly located, temporarily unavailable or inadequately documented. Users need accurate location information, compatibility details and a clear indication of when the information was last verified.

B. Emergency assistance

An EV user with a nearly depleted battery may not know where to find suitable assistance nearby. Potential helpers may be difficult to discover, lack suitable equipment or be unavailable.

C. Compatibility uncertainty

Vehicles have different charging interfaces, electrical requirements and battery configurations. A provider who can assist one EV cannot necessarily assist another.

D. Uncertain availability

A provider may have registered previously but no longer be available or have the necessary equipment ready. Users need current confirmation rather than relying on an old listing.

E. Limited discovery for local helpers

Eligible individuals and businesses may have suitable charging facilities or approved equipment but lack an effective way to connect with nearby EV users.

2.2 Proposed Solution

- Free charging-location directory and map.
- Vehicle profiles and compatibility-aware discovery.
- Location-based assistance requests.
- Provider availability and equipment-readiness confirmation.
- Transparent provider pricing.
- Paid contact access for eligible confirmed providers.
- Provider registration and request management.
- Community station submissions and reports.
- Safety, verification and complaint-handling processes.

3. Goals and Non-Goals

3.1 Product Goals

1. Allow users to find nearby charging stations.
2. Provide station coordinates and navigation links.
3. Allow users to save multiple EVs.
4. Help users find providers compatible with their selected vehicle.
5. Require providers to confirm availability, readiness and price before contact unlock.
6. Provide a clear, secure contact-access payment flow.
7. Allow eligible providers to register and manage their services.
8. Support community contributions to station data.
9. Provide administrators with tools to moderate stations and providers.
10. Work well on mobile browsers.

3.2 Non-Goals for the MVP

- Native Android and iOS applications.
- Manufacturing or selling EV batteries.
- Operating charging stations directly.
- Providing an in-house emergency rescue fleet.
- Guaranteeing provider arrival or successful charging.
- Supporting every EV model and charging standard.
- Remote control of charging equipment or battery diagnostics.
- Predictive battery-range AI.

- Holding or distributing payments for providers' actual service fees.
- Expanding nationwide before validating the initial market.

4. Target Users and Personas

Persona	Needs	Success condition
Everyday EV rider	Find stations, check compatibility, get assistance if battery is low.	Find a practical charging option or suitable provider quickly.
Delivery rider	Reduce downtime, locate charging and assistance, understand price.	Identify practical alternatives with minimal disruption.
Assistance provider	Register services, set area and availability, respond to requests.	Receive relevant requests and manage them efficiently.
Administrator	Moderate stations and providers, investigate complaints and refunds.	Maintain data quality, trust and safety.

5. Product Scope and Priority

Priorities use MoSCoW: P0 = must have; P1 = should have; P2 = could have; Future = not planned for the MVP.

Feature	Priority	Requirement
Responsive homepage	P0	Three primary actions
Charging map and list	P0	Search and display stations
Station details and navigation	P0	Address, coordinates, source, status and map link
Station reporting	P0	Report missing or inaccurate information
Authentication and vehicles	P0	Secure accounts and multiple vehicle profiles
Provider registration	P0	Service and equipment listings
Compatibility-aware matching	P0	Exclude known incompatible options
Help requests and responses	P0	Request, accept and decline
Readiness confirmation	P0	Timestamped confirmation with expiry
Contact payment and protection	P0 for paid launch	Verify payment before disclosing contact
Admin dashboard	P0	Moderation and oversight
Complaint/refund workflow	P0 for paid launch	Handle eligible failures
Reviews and push notifications	P1	Feedback and status updates
Subscriptions and provider analytics	P1	After demand validation
Route-based charging and local languages	P2	Later enhancements
Predictive battery assistance	Future	Requires reliable vehicle and route data

The free station-discovery MVP can launch before payments. Paid contact unlocks must not launch until compatibility checks, readiness expiry, payment verification, contact protection and refund handling work end to end.

6. Functional Requirements

6.1 Module A: Homepage

- **FR-HOME-001:** Display product name and primary navigation.
- **FR-HOME-002:** Display Find EV Charging, Get Nearby Help and Earn by Helping.
- **FR-HOME-003:** Explain that station discovery and navigation are free.
- **FR-HOME-004:** Provide registration and login access.
- **FR-HOME-005:** Support desktop, tablet and mobile screens.
- **FR-HOME-006:** Never claim station or provider availability without supporting data.

Acceptance criteria: All three actions are easy to find; each opens the correct section; the homepage is mobile-usable; no fabricated station counts or availability claims appear.

6.2 Module B: Charging Station Discovery

- **FR-CHG-001:** Search by location, area or landmark.
- **FR-CHG-002:** Allow optional location permission for nearby search.
- **FR-CHG-003:** Support manual search when permission is denied.
- **FR-CHG-004:** Provide map and list views.
- **FR-CHG-005:** Filter by distance.
- **FR-CHG-006:** Where reliable data exists, filter by connector, charging type, speed and compatibility.
- **FR-CHG-007:** Provide a station details page.
- **FR-CHG-008:** Display source, verification status and last verification date where known.
- **FR-CHG-009:** Open navigation using station coordinates.
- **FR-CHG-010:** Allow users to report inaccurate information.
- **FR-CHG-011:** Allow missing station submissions for review.
- **FR-CHG-012:** Keep basic station discovery and navigation free.

Acceptance criteria: Valid searches return matching records; map and list results open station details; navigation opens the selected coordinates; unknown live availability is labelled unknown; user submissions remain unverified until reviewed; basic discovery works without login.

6.3 Module C: My Vehicles

- **FR-VEH-001:** Allow multiple vehicles per user.
- **FR-VEH-002:** Store manufacturer, model, variant and year where available.
- **FR-VEH-003:** Store battery and charging specifications only when available from reliable sources.
- **FR-VEH-004:** Track specification source and verification status.
- **FR-VEH-005:** Allow vehicle edits and removal.
- **FR-VEH-006:** Require a selected vehicle for vehicle-specific help requests.
- **FR-VEH-007:** Never infer compatibility solely from brand or connector name.

Acceptance criteria: Users can save multiple vehicles; a saved vehicle can be selected for help; unknown specifications remain unknown; user data is isolated; known incompatibilities exclude a provider from eligible matches.

6.4 Module D: Provider Registration and Management

- **FR-PROV-001:** Allow registered users to apply as providers.

- **FR-PROV-002:** Verify provider phone numbers.
- **FR-PROV-003:** Require service categories.
- **FR-PROV-004:** Record equipment and supported vehicle configurations.
- **FR-PROV-005:** Set service radius and availability.
- **FR-PROV-006:** Confirm price before contact unlock.
- **FR-PROV-007:** Distinguish phone, identity, equipment and business verification.
- **FR-PROV-008:** Allow admin review or rejection.
- **FR-PROV-009:** Allow providers to accept or decline requests.
- **FR-PROV-010:** Allow providers to update availability.
- **FR-PROV-011:** Do not show providers as eligible for services they cannot safely provide.

Acceptance criteria: Required reviews are complete before paid requests; availability is visible; providers can accept or decline; confirmed prices cannot be silently changed; administrators can suspend providers.

6.5 Module E: Get Nearby Help

- **FR-HELP-001:** Require vehicle selection for vehicle-specific requests.
- **FR-HELP-002:** Accept shared or manually entered location.
- **FR-HELP-003:** Require an assistance category.
- **FR-HELP-004:** Allow search-radius selection.
- **FR-HELP-005:** Match service area and known compatibility.
- **FR-HELP-006:** Send requests to providers for accept/decline.
- **FR-HELP-007:** Before contact unlock, require confirmation of availability, readiness, compatibility and price.
- **FR-HELP-008:** Record confirmation timestamp and expiry.
- **FR-HELP-009:** Require reconfirmation after expiry.
- **FR-HELP-010:** Show price and service details before payment.
- **FR-HELP-011:** Support reporting failed, cancelled or misleading requests.
- **FR-HELP-012:** Offer alternatives when no eligible provider is available.

Acceptance criteria: Known incompatible providers are not eligible; a provider must respond before being confirmed; expired confirmations cannot be unlocked; users can compare eligible providers; no-match results offer alternatives.

6.6 Module F: Contact Access and Payments

Initial pricing hypotheses: free station discovery; ■19 for one emergency contact unlock; ■79/month for a future customer plan with defined usage; free provider basic plan; potential ■199/month provider plus plan. Prices must be tested and are not validated market rates.

- **FR-PAY-001:** Separate the platform contact-access fee from the provider service fee.
- **FR-PAY-002:** Show price, entitlement and refund terms before payment.
- **FR-PAY-003:** Verify payment on the backend using the gateway's supported process.
- **FR-PAY-004:** Create an entitlement after successful verification.
- **FR-PAY-005:** Failed or unverified payments must not reveal contact details.
- **FR-PAY-006:** Make payment processing idempotent to prevent duplicate entitlements.
- **FR-PAY-007:** Support eligible refunds or credits.
- **FR-PAY-008:** Maintain transaction and payment statuses.
- **FR-PAY-009:** Keep provider service payments separate in the initial version.

- **FR-PAY-010:** Enforce contact access on the server.

Acceptance criteria: Frontend manipulation cannot unlock contact; verified payment grants the defined entitlement; failed payment grants none; duplicate callbacks do not create duplicate charges or entitlements; users can see transaction status.

> **Contact access buys a defined platform feature—not guaranteed rescue, provider arrival or successful charging.**

6.7 Module G: Admin Dashboard

- **FR-ADMIN-001:** Separate protected administrator access.
- **FR-ADMIN-002:** Approve, reject, edit and remove stations.
- **FR-ADMIN-003:** Review reports and duplicate listings.
- **FR-ADMIN-004:** Review provider and equipment records.
- **FR-ADMIN-005:** Suspend accounts.
- **FR-ADMIN-006:** Review disputes and eligible refunds.
- **FR-ADMIN-007:** Log sensitive administrative actions.
- **FR-ADMIN-008:** Display operational statistics.

Acceptance criteria: Ordinary users cannot access admin endpoints; permissions are enforced; sensitive actions are logged; reports can be reviewed; unsafe providers can be suspended.

7. User Journeys

7.1 Find a Charging Station

1. User opens EV Connect and selects Find EV Charging.
2. User shares location or searches manually.
3. System displays nearby stations.
4. User applies filters and opens a station.
5. User checks address, compatibility details and verification status.
6. User selects Navigate and the mapping application opens the location.

Payment: None. **Login:** Not required for basic discovery.

7.2 Get Nearby Help

1. User selects Get Nearby Help and logs in if required.
2. User selects a vehicle, confirms location and chooses assistance type and radius.
3. System returns potential matches and sends requests to providers.
4. Providers confirm compatibility, availability, readiness and price.
5. User compares eligible providers and sees contact-access terms.
6. User pays or uses an eligible pass.
7. Backend authorises and reveals the contact details.
8. Customer and provider coordinate the service; user can report the outcome.

Failure handling: Expired confirmations require reconfirmation. If no match exists, the system offers alternatives.

7.3 Become a Helper

1. User registers as a provider and verifies their phone.
2. Provider creates a profile and registers services and equipment.
3. Required information is reviewed by an administrator.
4. Approved provider sets service radius and availability.
5. Provider receives a request and accepts or declines.
6. Provider confirms readiness and price.
7. Customer may unlock contact; both parties coordinate the service.
8. Both parties can submit feedback or complaints.

8. Information Architecture

Area	Proposed routes
Public	/, /charging, /charging/:stationId, /how-it-works, /safety, /faq, /about, /contact, /privacy, /terms, /refund-policy
Customer	/login, /register, /vehicles, /vehicles/add, /help/new, /help/:requestId, /requests, /payments, /account
Provider	/provider/register, /provider/dashboard, /provider/equipment, /provider/services, /provider/requests, /provider/availability, /provider/profile, /provider/subscription
Admin	/admin, /admin/stations, /admin/station-reports, /admin/providers, /admin/equipment, /admin/requests, /admin/payments, /admin/disputes, /admin/audit-logs

These routes are proposed conventions. All routes and API endpoints must enforce appropriate authentication and authorisation.

9. Technical Requirements

9.1 Recommended Technology Stack

Layer	Technology	Purpose
Frontend	React + TypeScript	Responsive user interface
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Consistent design
Backend	Node.js + Express	APIs and business logic
Database	PostgreSQL	Persistent application data
Geospatial	PostGIS	Nearby station and provider search
Authentication	Firebase Authentication or equivalent	Account access
Maps	Google Maps Platform or alternative	Maps and location search
Payments	Suitable Indian payment gateway	Contact passes and subscriptions
Notifications	Firebase Cloud Messaging or equivalent	Push notifications
Hosting	Appropriate cloud platform	Deployment
Monitoring	Error/performance monitoring	Reliability and debugging

Check current pricing, API restrictions, data-processing terms and service availability before selecting external services.

9.2 High-Level Architecture

- **Frontend:** Map and station views, vehicle forms, provider cards, request status, checkout and authorised contact display.
- **Backend:** Authentication, authorisation, nearby search, compatibility rules, readiness expiry, requests, payment verification and moderation.
- **Database:** Users, vehicles, stations, providers, equipment, requests, entitlements, payment references, reports and audit logs.
- **External services:** Maps/geocoding, authentication, payment gateway and notifications.

9.3 Core Data Models

Entity	Key fields
User	id, display_name, phone_verification_status, email if collected, role, created_at, account_status
Vehicle	id, user_id, manufacturer, model, variant, model_year, battery/charging specs, specification_source, verification_status
Charging Station	id, name, location, address, landmark, operator, access_type, source, verification_status, last_verified_at
Provider	id, user_id, display_name, service_radius, availability_status, verification_level, approval_status
Provider Equipment	id, provider_id, equipment_category, manufacturer, model, supported configurations, compatibility source, review status
Help Request	id, user_id, vehicle_id, requested_service, location, search_radius, request_status, created_at, expires_at
Provider Response	id, request_id, provider_id, response_status, compatibility_status, readiness_status, confirmed_price, confirmed_at, expires_at
Contact Unlock	id, user_id, provider_id, request_id, payment_reference, entitlement_status, unlocked_at
Payment	id, user_id, gateway_reference, payment_type, amount, currency, payment_status, refund_status, created_at

These are conceptual data models. Implementation may add fields, normalise relationships or change naming conventions.

10. Non-Functional Requirements

10.1 Performance

- Target main-page load time of approximately 2.5 seconds or less under agreed mobile test conditions.
- Target typical nearby-search response time under 2 seconds in the initial environment.
- Display loading and error states for slow operations.
- Load maps and large assets efficiently.

10.2 Availability

- Target 99.5% monthly availability once production monitoring and operations are established.
- Handle temporary map, payment and notification failures gracefully.
- Do not mark payments or contact unlocks successful based solely on frontend events.

10.3 Security

- Use HTTPS in production.
- Apply role-based access control and input validation.
- Rate-limit authentication, requests and payment endpoints.
- Verify payment events server-side.

- Avoid storing card details.
- Protect phone numbers and precise locations.
- Maintain administrative audit logs and secure secrets.
- Back up the database and test restoration.

10.4 Privacy

- Request location permission and support manual entry.
- Collect only necessary personal information.
- Limit exposure of exact customer locations.
- Explain location and contact-data usage.
- Provide account deletion and retention procedures.
- Restrict access to identity documents.
- Obtain appropriate consent for notifications and location processing.

The production privacy policy and data-handling process must be reviewed against applicable Indian legal requirements.

10.5 Accessibility

- Readable fonts and sufficient contrast.
- Keyboard navigation and labelled controls.
- Status labels that do not rely on colour alone.
- Useful form-validation messages.
- Screen-reader support for important actions.
- A simple emergency-assistance flow.

10.6 Browser Support

Support current major versions of Chrome, Edge, Firefox and Safari, and test the mobile interface on Android and iOS browsers.

11. Safety, Compliance and Operational Risks

Risk	Mitigation
Compatibility and electrical safety	Use credible specifications and manufacturer guidance; never recommend improvised connections or treat batteries as interchangeable.
Provider no-show	Timestamped confirmations, short expiry, reporting, reviews and a published refund/credit policy.
Inaccurate station data	Track source and verification time; accept community reports; review high-impact reports.
Insufficient provider coverage	Start locally, recruit providers before promoting paid help, monitor coverage and offer alternatives.
Payment disputes	Confirm readiness before payment, define contact-access terms, publish refund conditions and keep audit records.
Legal and regulatory uncertainty	Obtain appropriate advice on consumer protection, privacy, charging/battery-swapping rules, electrical safety, liability, tax and payment processing.

A provider's confirmation is an availability signal, not a guarantee of arrival or a substitute for compatibility and safety checks.

12. Monetisation Strategy

12.1 Initial Revenue Model

The proposed initial model charges a one-time fee for unlocking a confirmed provider's contact details.

Plan	Hypothetical price	Scope
Free	■0	Station discovery, details, search and navigation
Emergency Contact Pass	■19	One eligible contact unlock
Customer monthly plan	■79/month	Potential future plan with a defined allowance
Provider Basic	■0	Basic provider listing
Provider Plus	■199/month	Potential future management tools and analytics

These prices are hypotheses and must be tested. Begin with one-time contact access before adding recurring subscriptions.

12.2 Revenue Validation

- Measure willingness to pay and paid conversion.
- Track contact unlocks per customer, failures and refunds.
- Measure repeat usage and provider retention.
- Estimate customer acquisition cost and contribution margin.
- Avoid depending on subscriptions before demand is demonstrated.

13. Success Metrics and KPIs

Category	Metric
Discovery	Station searches; search-to-detail conversion; recently verified listings; report volume; audited data accuracy; useful-result rate.
Marketplace	Approved providers; compatible response rate; provider response rate; median response time; confirmation expiry; contact conversion; no-show rate; complaints and refunds.
Business	Paid unlocks; revenue per paying customer; customer acquisition cost; repeat usage; provider retention; contribution margin per unlock.

13.1 Initial Validation Targets

Metric	Initial target
Audited charging locations	50–100
Recruited providers	10–20
Station records with traceable source	100%
Help requests receiving at least one suitable response	At least 60% in the pilot area
Confirmation expiry and payment success	Measure baseline before setting targets
Willingness to pay	Validate with actual purchase tests

Targets are experiments, not forecasts or guarantees. Evaluate response-rate targets only after sufficient genuine requests have been collected.

14. Testing and Quality Assurance

14.1 Functional Testing

- Registration and login; multiple vehicle creation; station search and filters.
- Station detail navigation; missing station submissions; provider registration and equipment review.
- Help request creation; provider acceptance and rejection; readiness confirmation and expiry.
- Contact unlocking; payment success and failure; refunds and credits; admin moderation.

14.2 Security Testing

- Attempt to access another user's private data.
- Attempt to access administrator routes as a normal user.
- Attempt contact unlock without payment or with an expired confirmation.
- Manipulate prices, replay payment notifications and submit excessive requests.
- Attempt to bypass compatibility checks or access exact locations without permission.

14.3 Usability Testing

- Can users find a station without help?
- Do users understand verification labels and contact-access pricing?
- Can providers respond quickly?
- Do users understand what happens when no provider is available?
- Can users report problems easily?

14.4 Payment Testing

Use the payment gateway's test environment before accepting real money. Verify success, failure, cancellation, delayed and duplicate callbacks, refunds, and entitlement reuse/expiry rules.

15. MVP Release Plan

Phase	Estimated duration	Deliverables
1. Planning and design	1–2 weeks	Pilot area, vehicle scope, data sources, wireframes, database, compatibility and safety rules.
2. Free discovery MVP	2–4 weeks	Homepage, map/list, search, station details, navigation, reports and initial admin tools.
3. Accounts and providers	2–3 weeks	Authentication, vehicles, provider registration, equipment, dashboard and review process.
4. Help marketplace	2–4 weeks	Requests, matching, responses, readiness, expiry, price display and request history.
5. Payments and production readiness	1–3 weeks	Contact payments, entitlement enforcement, refunds, security, privacy review, monitoring and pilot.

This is a planning estimate for a solo developer or small team with appropriate experience. Actual duration depends on skill, integrations and data availability.

15.1 Features to Defer

- AI chatbot and predictive battery analytics.

- Native Android and iOS applications.
- Large unsupported vehicle catalogues.
- Complex subscriptions before usage validation.
- Holding and distributing provider service payments.
- Nationwide listings before local data quality is established.

16. Release Acceptance Criteria

Charging discovery

- Users can search stations, view details and navigate.
- Source and verification status are visible.
- Users can report inaccurate information.
- Basic discovery remains free.

Vehicle compatibility

- Users can create multiple vehicle profiles.
- Vehicle-specific requests are linked to a selected vehicle.
- Known incompatibilities block eligible matching.
- Unknown compatibility is not labelled verified.

Provider marketplace

- Providers can register and submit equipment.
- Administrators can review required information.
- Users can submit requests and providers can accept or decline.
- Readiness and price are confirmed before contact unlock.
- Expired confirmations cannot be used for new unlocks.

Contact access

- Fee and terms are clear before payment.
- Backend verifies payments.
- Contact remains protected until access is authorised.
- Failed payments do not grant access.
- Eligible failures can be reported and handled.

Security and operations

- Permissions are enforced and private data protected.
- Payment failures are handled safely.
- Complaint handling is operational.
- Backups and monitoring are configured.
- Safety, privacy, terms and refund information are available.

17. Open Questions

1. Which Bengaluru localities are included in the first pilot?
2. Which electric scooter models and variants are supported initially?
3. Which provider types can offer each assistance category?
4. What evidence is required to approve equipment compatibility?
5. Will the first paid release use only a one-time contact pass?
6. What happens if a provider withdraws after confirmation or does not respond?
7. Will contact use direct phone disclosure or a masked-call solution?
8. Which station data sources permit commercial use?
9. What provider checks are proportionate to each service category?
10. Will customer-provider service payments remain outside the platform during the MVP?
11. Who will review reports and resolve complaints during the pilot?
12. Is EV Connect the final name or a working title?

Resolve these decisions before implementing the features that depend on them.

18. Final Product Recommendation

EV Connect should launch as a focused, mobile-first web application rather than an all-in-one EV super-app.

The three core experiences

- **Find EV Charging:** Free, useful station discovery with transparent data quality.
- **Get Nearby Help:** Compatibility-aware assistance discovery with fresh provider confirmation, clear pricing and controlled contact access.
- **Earn by Helping:** A structured way for eligible providers to list services, respond to requests and build trust.

> **The most important success factor is whether an EV user can find a genuinely suitable charging option or a responsive, compatible provider when they need help.**

Product principle: Build trust and reliability first, monetise useful access second, and expand only when real usage demonstrates demand.